

They'll ask for information like your name, Social Security number, and the name, address, and phone number of your former employer. Just like with a W-2 form, you can ask that taxes be taken out in the paycheck itself. (I opted for this on my denied application; I didn't want to pay taxes in a lump sum later.)

Then you get a log-in and file each week for your payment. You won't get paid unless you file. You can get direct deposit too, which is very convenient. You can also check on your online account to see how much compensation you have left.

There's absolutely no shame in getting unemployment. In fact, I'll yell at you if you don't. Get all the help offered. Don't feel badly about it.



TAKEAWAYS

- ° The upshot of the gig economy is that it's easy to find "side hustles" to make ends meet, but it can feel very unstable and stressful juggling all those different jobs. Try to create a schedule for yourself that replicates a working week schedule and solidify a reasonable number of working to not-working hours.
- ° Be prepared to go through several hustles before you find one that works out.
- ° Even when someone seems successful, don't make assumptions about how much that person is making. It may be a lot; it may not be. You don't know their expenses or history with money. Income does not necessarily equal wealth.
- ° Let's all be more transparent about how we get our money! We have to make it, so we should be honest about where it's coming from. Sharing this information with friends helps us not feel so isolated and might provide leads for future income.
- ° Ain't no shame in the applying-for-unemployment game!